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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Plans for tariffs spread uncertainty

President restores 25% tax on imports of steel, aluminum

By Josh Boak
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump on Monday removed the exceptions and exemptions from his 2018 tariffs on steel, meaning that all steel imports will be taxed at a minimum of 25%. Trump also hiked his 2018 aluminum tariffs to 25% from 10%.

“We were being pummeled by both friend and foe alike,” Trump said as he signed two proclamations changing his orders during his first term that go into effect on March 4. “It’s time for our great industries to come back to America.”

The moves are part of an aggressive push by the president to reset global trade, with Trump saying that tax hikes on the people and companies buying foreign-made products will ultimately strengthen domestic manufacturing.

But the tariffs would hit allies as the four biggest sources of steel imports are Canada, Brazil, Mexico and South Korea, according to the American Iron and Steel Institute.

Trump also intends this week to reset U.S. taxes on all imports to match the same levels charged by other countries, all of which comes on top of the 10% tariffs he already put on China, China’s retaliatory tariffs that started Monday, and the U.S. tariffs planned for Canada and Mexico that have been suspended until March 1.

Monday’s tariffs almost immediately drew criticism from Canada, the largest source of steel imports. Candace Laing, president and CEO of the Canadian Chamber of Commerce, said that Trump was a destabilizing force in the global economy.

“Today’s news makes it clear that perpetual uncertainty is here to stay,” said Laing.

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Former Illinois Gov. Rod Blagojevich arrives home in the Ravenswood Manor neighborhood Monday. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Trump accords full pardon to Blagojevich

Move comes 5 years after commuting disgraced former governor’s sentence

By Rick Pearson, Ray Long and Jeremy Gornier
Chicago Tribune

Nearly five years after commuting former Gov. Rod Blagojevich’s federal prison sentence, President Donald Trump on Monday granted a full pardon to the disgraced former governor who was convicted more than 13 years ago on an array of corruption charges, including fundraising schemes and attempting to sell a

U.S. Senate seat for his personal benefit.

Blagojevich, outside his Ravenswood Manor home before the president officially signed the pardon, told reporters he will “always be profoundly grateful to President Trump for everything he’s done for me and my family.”

“It’s everlasting gratitude,” Blagojevich said. “He’s a great guy. I think the world of him. I think he’s going to do great for America.”

In signing the pardon in the Oval Office later Monday, Trump called Blagojevich a “very fine person” and said it was time to “let him have a normal life.”

The pardon comes as the president is also said to be considering Blagojevich as the next U.S. ambassador to Serbia, where the former governor’s family comes from. Though he was a Democrat while he was an elected state representative, congressman and governor, Blagojevich became a

devout Trump political disciple after receiving his commutation Feb. 18, 2020.

Asked whether he’s considering appointing Blagojevich the ambassador to Serbia, Trump said Monday, “No, but I would.” Blagojevich declined to comment Monday afternoon about the ambassadorship possibility.

Unlike the commutation,

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A UPS cargo jet takes off in front of one of the three FAA air traffic control towers at O'Hare International Airport in Chicago on Jan. 29. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Chicago has not been immune from recent air traffic controller shortages

By Sarah Freishtat
Chicago Tribune

The late-January collision between a passenger jet and an Army helicopter brought renewed attention to an issue that has plagued the nation’s air system for years: a shortage of air traffic controllers. And the busy Chicago air corridor has not been immune.

Air traffic control facilities at the city’s two airports, plus two

other regional centers, failed to meet a working group’s target staffing levels as of September 2023, according to the most recent published numbers.

For example, in one facility that oversees planes coming to and going from Chicago, the number of fully certified controllers was about 70% of the target staffing levels recommended by the union and Federal Aviation Administration working group. At another

regional facility, the number of fully certified controllers was 82% of the group’s recommendation.

Shortages in Chicago were not as acute as those in some other major cities, like New York. Still, they can force air traffic controllers to work overtime and face fatigue in a busy air space that has been recognized as among the nation’s most critical because of

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Controversial police shooting settlement held from council panel vote

\$1.25 million award to family in limbo

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

A controversial settlement is now in City Council limbo after a deal to award \$1.25 million to the family of a man shot and killed by police after firing at officers first was not brought up for a planned vote Monday.

Aldermen had appeared poised for a tense debate over the settlement recommended by city attorneys for the family of Dexter Reed as a way to avoid a potentially more costly payout in court. But Ald. Pat Dowell, chair of the City Council’s Finance Committee, withheld the settlement instead of letting committee members decide whether to send it on to the full council.

Dowell did not say why she did so. Aldermen often delay planned votes when they do not have the support to pass an item.



Nicole Banks breaks down after speaking briefly about the death of her son Dexter Reed during a news conference outside the 11th District police station in Chicago on April 24. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

It’s not clear when the Reed settlement might now come up for consideration in the Finance Committee.

Some aldermen believe the city should not settle Reed’s family’s lawsuit because Reed

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Governor signs ‘Karina’s Bill’

The measure enacted Monday spells out when law enforcement is required to take guns from alleged abusers. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Trump calls halt to penny production

President Donald Trump says he has directed the Treasury Department to stop minting new pennies, citing the rising cost. **Business, Page 2**

